CHAPTER 9

# SOUTH AFRICA, RIGHT OR WRONG

Representing South Africa remains a massive privilege.

It's true the international cricket schedule is demanding, with long periods spent away from home. And it's true that the pressure to perform in match after match is relentless, with so much resting on the simple number appearing after your name on the scoreboard or in the newspaper, there for all to see. If it's a 100, you're a hero. If it's a 0, you are quite literally a zero. There's no point complaining; that's the reality.

However, it is also true that very few individuals are given the honour of essentially going to work over and over again with the name of their country emblazoned on their chest or on their back.

I am a South African, and I am intensely proud to be a South African.

There are currently 196 sovereign states on this planet and, of course, each and every one of them is special to most of the people who live there. Each and every country cherishes its own history, traditions and identity, and it would be foolish to suggest that any one is somehow superior to any other.

That said, South Africa is special to me.

It is special primarily because of the people who live here, the overwhelming majority, the fundamentally good people who want nothing more than for our country to grow and develop, to prosper and realise